



SPONSOR: Rep. Michael Smith & Sen. Sturgeon
Reps. Burns, Collins, K. Johnson, D. Short; Sens. Hocker,
Mantzavinos, Townsend, Wilson

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
153rd GENERAL ASSEMBLY

HOUSE BILL NO. 120

AN ACT TO NAME THE HILL ON THE WEST BANK OF MILL CREEK LOCATED ON NEW CASTLE PARCEL
NUMBER 0803100018 AS “GENERAL WASHINGTON’S HILL OF DECEPTION”.

1 WHEREAS, on September 8, 1777, General George Washington and his Continental Army were in pursuit of
2 16,000 British and Hessian forces who were marching from the area of Cooch’s Bridge towards Philadelphia aiming to
3 seize the colonial capital; and

4 WHEREAS, General Washington’s force of 11,000 Continental soldiers were positioned along the east banks of
5 the Red Clay Creek, west of Newport, expecting the British to march towards the position and give battle; and

6 WHEREAS, on that day, the British did not advance to General Washington’s position as anticipated; and

7 WHEREAS, General Washington needed to determine the precise location of the British march in order to
8 reposition his Continental army advantageously for a battle that could end the war in Washington’s favor; and

9 WHEREAS, from the position at Red Clay Creek, General Washington ordered Brigadier General George
10 Weedon’s brigade to advance in a northwest direction to locate the British; and

11 WHEREAS, General Weedon’s brigade marched to a hill along the east banks of Mill Creek known as Lieutenant
12 McMichael’s Hill of Eminence overlooking an area known as Spring Grove, from where they observed British forces
13 positioned on the next hill located on the opposite side of Mill Creek where the historic Spring Grove Mill House stands
14 today; and

15 WHEREAS, gunfire was exchanged throughout the night between the two hills separated by Mill Creek; and

16 WHEREAS, this combat event would become known as General Weedon’s Foray at Spring Grove, one of the
17 most impactful event that occurred in Delaware during the Revolutionary War; and

18 WHEREAS, on July 20, 2023, Delaware Public Archives placed historical marker number NCC-264 next to the
19 driveway entrance of the Spring Grove Mill House at 3200 Stoney Batter Road, Wilmington, Delaware commemorating the
20 location as the “Site of General Weedon’s Foray at Spring Grove”; and

21 WHEREAS, General Washington, suspected that British General Howe’s mission of the foray was to prevent
22 General Washington from finding the 16,000 British forces encamping west of the foray on Limestone Road; and

23 WHEREAS, General Washington used the foray as a distraction, to secretly ride to Milltown and confirm the
24 location of the British Army, thereby deceiving General Howe into wrongly believing Washington was not aware of the
25 encampment location of the British Army; and

26 WHEREAS, General Washington's use of deception during the foray allowed Washington to make strategical
27 adjustments that enabled his forces to reach Chadds Ford in time to create defensive positions in preparation for the Battle
28 of Brandywine on September 11, thus preventing the British from seizing Philadelphia without the strong resistance
29 imposed by the Continental army in the Battle of Brandywine; and

30 WHEREAS, this boosted France's level of confidence in General Washington's ability to fight the war leading to
31 France's formal recognition of America as a sovereign nation, and France became fully committed to supporting the
32 American cause in the Revolutionary War; and

33 WHEREAS, French support was a significant factor in the United States of America winning the Revolutionary
34 War; and

35 WHEREAS, on July 4, 2026, the State of Delaware and the United States of America will be celebrating the
36 American Semiquincentennial, and the identification of significant Revolutionary War events and locations will enhance
37 the experience for all citizens and future generations;

38 NOW, THEREFORE:

39 BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF DELAWARE:

40 Section 1. The hill west of Mill Creek where the Spring Grove Mill House sits on New Castle County Parcel
41 number 0803100018 is hereby named "General Washington's Hill of Deception".

42 Section 2. Where appropriate, maps produced depicting General Washington's Hill of Deception will be labeled as
43 such.

SYNOPSIS

This bill names the hill west of Mill Creek situated on New Castle County parcel number 0803100018 where the Spring Grove Mill House sits as "General Washington's Hill of Deception". This is the site of one of the most impactful combat event that occurred on Delaware soil during the Revolutionary War.